TA studio brief — Analysing a practitioner without copying the page

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do we conduct rigorous visual analysis of a practitioner's work through annotated studies rather than biography copying?

TA practical setup & focus

Provide 6 cm viewfinders and demonstrate the 'squint test' so pupils can easily simplify complex prints into three tonal values for Box 1.

Studio kit: Practitioner exemplar prints, A3 analytical study boards, viewfinders, 2B-6B graphite, fineliners, water-based washes, oil pastels

Key words to prompt

• visual analysis: Examining how an artwork is constructed visually (tone, composition, mark-making) rather than copying biographical facts.

• tonal map: A simplified 3-to-5 value thumbnail that reveals where the artist placed darks, mid-tones, and lights.

• transcription: A focused study of a small section made to reverse-engineer the layer order and tool marks.

• intent: The meaning, mood, or visual impact the practitioner aimed to communicate.

• adaptation: Taking a structural or technical principle from a study and re-inventing it for your own subject.

Supported route steps

1. Shade the pre-outlined Box 1 Tonal map using dark, mid, and light pencil tones to match the print.

2. Place your viewfinder on the print and copy the layered marks inside Box 2.

3. In box 3, draw your own personal symbol using the same dark/mid/light layout and mark style.

4. Add three pointer notes explaining the layer order.

Check: 3-tone map, viewfinder close-up study, personal adaptation, and three pointer notes completed.

Review & exit support

Exit question: What is the purpose of drawing a simplified 3-value 'tonal map' when analysing an artwork?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review how to model visual practitioner analysis (Tonal map -> Transcription -> Adaptation) without biographical text copying.